Tatiana Papastylianou

Senior Product Designer · Design Lead

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PROFILE

Senior product designer and design lead with 4+ years building and shipping complex B2B SaaS tools, scalable design systems, and AI-assisted learning products across web, iOS, and Android. Human-centered, end-to-end designer comfortable at every scale — from 0→1 products to converging multiple apps into one and re-architecting the design system that ties them together. Leading teams and owning strategic, end-to-end product decisions aligned to business goals across global development groups, I solve complex problems and raise implementation quality through interaction design, prototyping, and close collaboration with engineers on design tokens, components, and handoff — with a track record of measurable design impact. Equally strong leading and delivering independently.

SELECTED IMPACT

- Improved user retention ~40% by fixing usability issues and optimising core learning flows.
- Increased user satisfaction ~15% through features informed by research and testing.
- Reduced design and development cost by building a reusable, token-driven design system and driving Storybook adoption with engineers — fewer build-time mismatches, fewer one-off components, faster handoff.
- Shipped a math education product from scratch, live at math.akelius.education, through three competing executive visions.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer May 2025 – Present

Akelius Languages & Math — educational applications for languages and mathematics

- Own UX and UI for a mathematics education product built from scratch (live at math.akelius.education), designing for scalable growth and iteration.
- Lead designer synthesising three conflicting stakeholder visions (founder, board, content editors) into one coherent, radically minimal shipped product.
- Design learning experiences and AI-powered features for the language-learning applications across web, iOS, and Android.
- Created a custom English learning-content typeface, extended with the additional glyphs required for Swedish, German, and French.
- Ship product and conversion-focused marketing surfaces — landing pages and campaigns — with design plus front-end (HTML/CSS) implementation when needed, supporting multi-brand launches.
- Drive cross-functional alignment with product and engineering on scope, priorities, and release decisions.

Design Lead & Product Owner, Websites Feb 2023 – May 2025

Akelius Technology — global real estate; tools used by field staff managing thousands of properties across Europe and North America

- Led a design team of three and owned web product direction with one to two developers.
- Primary design partner for large global engineering teams, improving implementation quality through prototypes, defined states, and clear annotations.
- Built and scaled a token-driven Figma component library and marketing design system across web, iOS, and Android — aligning naming and syntax with engineering and driving Storybook adoption so design and code share one source of truth.
- Supported ML-powered chatbot and text-cleaning helper experiences for messenger workflows.

User Interface Designer Dec 2021 – Feb 2023

- Designed interfaces for internal and external products, partnering closely with engineers to ship consistent experiences.
- Supported research and usability testing to validate changes and improve key flows.

Freelance Designer 2016 – 2021

- Graphic design, illustration, motion design, and web projects for clients across multiple industries.

DESIGN SYSTEMS

Architected and maintain a multi-library system at Akelius: a 24-family core component set shared across web and Android (platform-specific variants only where justified, e.g. top navigation and dialog) plus a dedicated iOS set; a separate Generator library for the content-authoring tool; and an illustration/icon library. Foundations include variable-bound type scales, colour tokens, responsive breakpoints, and explicit naming and handoff guidelines with a per-component responsive matrix.

SKILLS

- Product design — end-to-end product design, complex B2B workflows, information architecture, interaction design, human-centered design.
- Research & UX — user research, usability testing, user flows, wireframes, high-fidelity mockups, UI/UX principles, responsive design and breakpoints, accessibility (WCAG), iOS and Android design patterns.
- Prototyping — interactive prototypes, micro-interactions, design-to-code (HTML, CSS).
- Design systems — component libraries, design tokens and variables, Storybook, technical documentation and handoff standards, multi-brand.
- Collaboration & leadership — agile, cross-functional collaboration (product, engineering, research), stakeholder alignment, design leadership and mentorship.
- Tools — Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, Jira/Confluence, Notion, GitHub, AI/LLM tools for UX and prototyping.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

BA, International Relations — Ural State University (2007–2011). Self-taught product designer, 6+ years of practice.

- Google UX Design foundations · UX/UI specialisation with accessibility focus.
- Figma variables and conditionals · Figma-to-CSS implementation · UX research.

SELECTED RECOMMENDATIONS

“One of the best hires. Drives tasks to a solution.” — Andreas Wallén, CEO, Akelius Technology

“Fast, motivated, excellent eye for design. Would gladly welcome her back.” — Svenja Henrichs, direct manager, Akelius Technology

“Strategic thinker. Improves engagement and retention. Inspiring leader.” — Hadi Kashlan, senior engineer, Akelius Technology

INDEPENDENT PRODUCTS & WRITING

- IrisVault — iOS eye-wellness app (SwiftUI, StoreKit), available on the App Store.
- stePlan — freelance project-management app, available on the App Store, with landing page.
- No Water — A Designer's Confession — authored book for designers, with landing site.
- Additional prototypes: Bloom, Ballcy, Payd, The Era Engine, Local Secret.

LANGUAGES

Russian — native. English — professional.